PROactive PRONUNCIATION

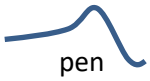
Syllables

What is a Syllable?

A syllable is a chunk of a word that has a vowel sound in it. You can think of a syllable as a clap in the word. If you are having an issue identifying syllables, look for the vowels- Each vowel carries the syllable. In English, we STRESS one syllable in each word and speed through the other syllables.

A one-syllable word could only be "clapped" with one clap.

With one-syllable words, there needs to be a clear wavy pitch change from high to low. Think of it as singing up on the vowel then down at the end.



pen	hair	that
bear	just	

A 2-syllable word would have 2 vowels, so 2 claps: For each 2-syllable word, you must still STRESS one syllable.



pa-per	**car**-pet	**af**-ter
pen-cil	**o**-pen	

A 3-syllable word would have 3 vowels, so 3 claps: You must still STRESS one syllable.

e-le-phant	le-mon-**aid**	**won**-der-ful
oc-to-pus	**af**-ter-math	**bo**-ttle-neck

A 4-syllable word would have 4 vowels, so 4 claps: You must still STRESS one syllable.

he-li-cop-ter	**wa-**ter-me-lon	**te**-le-vi-sion
el-e-va-tor	**a**-lli-ga-tor	pre-**dic-**ta-ble

We also have 5 and 6 syllable words. You must still STRESS one syllable.

re-**frid**-ger-a-tor	su-per-in-**ten**-dent
hi-ppo-**pa**-ta-mus	in-ter-**na**-tio-nal

The point here is that we can only choose ONE syllable in each word to be stressed or "lingered" on